Zillow® Rentals

Your listings on Zillow, Trulia and HotPads.

Lead Delivery API Guide

Dec 11, 2024

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Audience

This is a technical document for web developers and project managers tasked with creating an API endpoint to receive lead inquiries from listings published on Zillow Rentals platforms.

Use Case

Lead Delivery APIs are used to ingest lead data directly into a CRM or lead management system.

Deliverable

HTTP Post callback API endpoint capable of receiving lead data from Zillow Rentals.

Format

Header & Payload Example

Header

POST /request HTTP/1.1

content-type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded; charset=UTF-8

host: hotpads.com

content-length: 277

Payload (URL Encoded)

Unset


```
listingId=p01023&name=Rachel%20Lee&email=rachel%40gmail.com&phone=555-555-8378&
movingDate=20160926&numBedroomsSought=3&numBathroomsSought=2&message=Looking%20
for%20spacious%203%20bedroom%20apartment%20or%20house&listingStreet=246%20Tenne
ssee%20Avenue&listingUnit=C102&listingCity=Sunnyvale&listingPostalCode=94086&li
stingState=CA&listingContactEmail=propertymanager%40HaywardParkApartments.com&n
eighborhoods=%5B%22Park%20Merced%22%2C%20%22Sunset%22%5D&propertyTypesDesired=%
5B%22apartment%22%2C%20%22house%22%2C%20%22townhouse%22%5D&leaseLengthMonths=12
&introduction=Hello%20my%20name%20is%20Rachel&smoker=false&parkingTypeDesired=r
equired&incomeYearly=150000&creditScoreRangeJson=%7B%22creditScoreMin%22%3A675%
2C%22creditScoreMax%22%3A690%7D&movingFromCity=San%20Francisco&movingFromState=
CA&moveInTimeframe=asap&reasonForMoving=high%rent&employmentStatus=employed&job
Title=Software%Engineer&employer=Zillow&employmentStartDate=2015-09-27&employme
ntDetailsJson=%5B%7B%22jobTitle%22%3A%22Software%20Engineer%22%2C%22employer%22
%3A%22Google%22%2C%22startDate%22%3A%222012-07-21%22%2C%22endDate%22%3A%222015-
09-20%22%7D%5D&petDetailsJson=%5B%7B%22type%22%3A%22dog%22%2C%22breed%22%3A%22L
ab%22%2C%22size%22%3A%22huge%22%2C%22weightPounds%22%3A50%2C%22description%22%3
A%22Really%20awesome%20lab%22%7D%2C%7B%22type%22%3A%22cat%22%2C%22size%22%3A%22
small%22%2C%22description%22%3A%22Really%20annoying%20cat%22%7D%5D&leadType=tou
rRequest
```

Field Details

Field Name	Notes	Example
listingId	Feed sourced listing ID	listingId=p01023
name	Renter name	name=Rachel Lee
Email	Renter's email	email=rachel@gmail.com
phone	Renter phone number	phone=555-555-8378
movingDate	YYYYMMDD (omitted if null)	movingDate=20230916
numBedroomsSought	Integer, 0 is studio	numBedroomsSought=3
numBathroomsSought	Integer	numBathroomsSought=2
message	Text blob from lead form	message=Looking for spacious 3 bedroom apartment or house
listingStreet	Listing Street Address	listingStreet=246 Tennessee Avenue
listingUnit	Listing Unit Number	listingUnit=C102
listingCity	Listing City	listingCity=Sunnyvale
listingPostalCode	Listing Zip Code	listingPostalCode=94086
listingState	Listing State Code	listingState=CA
listingContactEmail	Contact email address for this listing (not used when sending leads via API).	listingContactEmail=propertymanager@HaywardParkApartments.com
neighborhoods	Neighborhoods of interest	neighborhoods=["Park Merced", "Sunset"]
propertyTypesDesired	Property types of interest	propertyTypesDesired=["apartment", "house", "townhouse"]
leaseLengthMonths	lease duration	leaseLengthMonths=12
introduction	Text blob from renter profile	introduction=Hello my name is Rachel
smoker	Boolean	smoker=false
parkingTypeDesired	Enumerated: 'required', 'not needed'	parkingTypeDesired=required
incomeYearly	Yearly income in US dollars	incomeYearly=150000
creditScoreRangeJson	Credit Score	creditScoreRangeJson={"creditScoreMin":675,"creditScore

		Max":690}
movingFromCity	Renter origination city	movingFromCity=San Francisco
movingFromState	Renter origination state	movingFromState=CA
moveInTimeframe	Enum: 'asap', 'flexible', 'week', 'month', 'twoWeeks', 'twoMonths'	moveInTimeframe=asap
employmentStatus	Enumerated: 'unemployed', 'student', 'retired', 'employed'	employmentStatus=employed
jobTitle	Job Title	jobTitle=Software Engineer
employer	Employer	employer=Zillow
employmentStartDate	yyyy-mm-dd	employmentStartDate=2020-09-27
employmentDetailsJson	Employment Details	employmentDetailsJson=[{"jobTitle":"Software Engineer","employer":"Google","startDate":"2012-07-21","endDate":"2015-09-20"}]
petDetailsJson	Renter pet details	petDetailsJson=[{"type":"dog","breed":"Lab","size":"huge","weightPounds":50,"description":"Really awesome lab"},{"type":"cat","size":"small","description":"Really annoying cat"}]
leadType	Lead enumerated types: question tourRequest applicationRequest	leadType=tourRequest
providerModelId	Model ID for multifamily listings, otherwise 0	providerModelId=0

Bold Italic indicates that the lead payload will always include this data.

Implementation

Applying & Triggering the API

Following are common ways that lead APIs can be applied or triggered:

- Feed - applied to all listings within a specific feed.
- Company ID - applied to a specific company ID within a feed.
- Email Domain - API is triggered for any listings with a specific contact email domain.

Note that we can apply the API based on other criteria, but these are the most common ways to automatically trigger an API.

Routing Leads

Triggering the Lead API

If the listing ID from the feed is available to the API recipient, routing the lead to the correct listing is trivial, since that ID is unique by listing and can easily be used for routing.

Even for multi-famil

But what if you are not the feed provider and the feed ID is unknown?

You can match the leads to a listing by address, but not confidently because the address contains multiple components that are parsed separately and the address may not match exactly.

If the lead API is being triggered by email domain, one option is to provide a unique prefix for each property's contact email, and use that email prefix to route leads, i.e. propertyId@CRMdomain.com where the domain triggers the api, and the prefix "propertyId" is the unique listing ID used for routing the lead to the correct property.

Multi-Family Listings

Listings can be routed by the listing ID, but for multi-family listings, you may also want to match leads to specific floorplans or available units within the listing.

In this case, the model ID from the feed is provided within the lead payload when a lead is made on a specific unit or floorplan. This ID is taken from the feed, so it is only relevant where the feed provider is also receiving and routing the lead via the API.

Security

By default the API is configured without a security header or security token.

Security Header/Token

Our lead delivery API supports a static security header and/or token which we can configure & test prior to deploying to production.

OAuth

Our lead delivery API does not currently support the OAuth framework.

Lead Delivery Responses

Success

When the lead is delivered successfully, the endpoint must respond with the standard http 200 or 202 success code. Note that the 200 success code should indicate that the lead was received successfully by the endpoint *and* it was able to be parsed and placed within your data-store.

If you respond with either 202/200 success, but the lead can't be routed, we will not attempt to redeliver the lead if the routing fails, so you may want to respond with a descriptive failure code if the lead data is received successfully, but cannot be parsed/routed.

Endpoint Failure & Lead Redelivery

If a lead is not received successfully or is received but cannot be handled by the parser, the endpoint should respond with a http failure code as well as information about the failure.

A failed delivery will trigger automatic redelivery. This means that if your endpoint is unavailable for any reason, intentional or not, as long as you respond with an error message, your leads will not be lost, and will automatically be redelivered once it is available again.

Entertaining list of http response codes: https://http.cat/

Examples of Failure Responses we receive:

```
Unset

HTTP/1.1 400 Bad Request,
{"errorCode":"INVALID_TRACKING_EMAIL","errorMessage":"Property with
tracking email 'email@domain.com' does not exist"}

HTTP/1.1 500 Internal Server Error, {"errorMessage":"received error
status code 500"}

{"status":"400 - Bad Request","messages":["This property (xxxxxx) does not have
a valid e-mail address or it has recently been deleted. This lead will not
reach the property manager."],"code":"40002","moreInfo":""}

Could not identify the property.
```

We review lead delivery errors daily and detailed failure responses make it easier to troubleshoot and resolve lead errors.

Testing

Leads can be delivered via our test platform so there is no need to create or modify production listings for testing purposes.

Once you are ready to test your endpoint, we can configure it on our test environment and you can send and receive leads.

Deploying to Production

Once you are satisfied that leads are being successfully delivered to your endpoint and ingested into your lead management platform, we can deploy the API to production.

Third-Party Lead API's

Zillow Rentals supports many third-party lead delivery API's. Please ask to see if your provider's API is already supported.